JIANG NAN 江南	**Preventive Maintenance Policy**	Document No.:	IKQAP#014
		Revision No.	2
	Imperial Kitchen Group Inc.,	Effective Date:	July 6, 2026

1. Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to ensure all Imperial Kitchen Group Inc. facility equipment—including industrial production lines, high-capacity coolers, and heavy equipment—operates at peak efficiency and safety. By establishing a rigorous maintenance schedule, the facility aims to prevent mechanical failures that could lead to temperature fluctuations, contamination, or safety hazards, thereby ensuring consistent regulatory compliance.

2. Scope

This policy maintains a comprehensive reach, governing all mechanical systems, refrigeration units, and production machinery—including auxiliary systems like HVAC, water filtration, and compressed air—across the warehouse, retail store, and commissary facilities. The scope extends to all personnel, including in-house technicians, third-party contractors, and sanitation crews, ensuring that every stage of the equipment lifecycle is subject to rigorous oversight. By encompassing everything from loading docks to high-care processing zones, this holistic approach eliminates gaps in mechanical or sanitary protocols, ensuring that all infrastructure contributing to the cold chain and food processing meets strict standards for calibration, maintenance, and documentation.

3. Responsibilities

3.1. Facility Manager

Shall design, implement, and oversee the master preventive maintenance schedule for all primary building infrastructure, including HVAC systems, electrical grids, main plumbing networks, and the structural building envelope. They proactively program routine inspections and servicing cycles to mitigate utility failures, minimize structural downtime, and extend the operational lifecycle of core facility assets. The manager also manages the recurring testing and preventive upkeep of critical facility life-safety systems, such as fire suppression, backup generators, and emergency lighting, to ensure continuous regulatory compliance and audit readiness. Shall utilize facility management data and building automation systems to track equipment performance trends, optimize the preventive maintenance budget, and direct specialized third-party contractors executing major infrastructure servicing.

3.2. Warehouse Manager

Shall hold ultimate accountability for equipment oversight and coordinate maintenance schedules for forklifts, pallets and electric batteries, while strictly enforcing daily pre-shift operator inspections and immediate lockout/tagout (LOTO) protocols for defective machinery. Facility infrastructure responsibilities include overseeing scheduled maintenance for dock levelers, doors, HVAC systems, lighting, and electrical panels, as well as monitoring high-traffic flooring to prevent material handling equipment damage and tipping hazards. To ensure racking structural integrity, the manager implements routine inspections for structural defects, enforces a blame-free damage reporting system, and maintains compliance with load-capacity labeling standards.

3.3. Quality Assurance (QA)

Shall be responsible for serving as the critical authority for regulatory compliance, data integrity, and risk management across all technical operations. This role demands direct oversight of the rigorous technical validation of equipment calibrations, ensuring that all industrial sensors, automated continuous temperature monitoring logs, and climate control systems operate within precise, pre-established tolerances. The QA systematically reviews and signs off on calibration certificates, conducts routine audits of environmental data streams to detect anomalies, and manages the Corrective and Preventive Action (CAPA) process whenever a deviation occurs. By maintaining an uncompromised validation framework, QA ensures that all facility hardware and tracking systems remain continuously audit-ready and legally compliant.

3.4. Maintenance Employees

Shall be responsible for conducting direct inspections of industrial production lines and documenting large-scale cleaning and maintenance schedules.Also responsible for maintaining a comprehensive master schedule that encompasses all equipment within the specified scope. Maintenance intervals for these assets are strategically determined by evaluating manufacturer specifications, historical performance data, and potential risks to food safety. Within this framework, prioritization is strictly enforced: refrigeration units housing “Time/Temperature Control for Safety (TCS) foods”, are officially classified as “Critical Equipment” and must take precedence in all scheduling and service activities.

3.5. Kitchen Employees

Shall be responsible for maintaining the operational readiness, safety, and hygiene of all culinary equipment while strictly adhering to established food safety protocols. All kitchen employees require the immediate reporting of any equipment malfunctions, performance deviations, or mechanical anomalies to management and the maintenance team to mitigate operational downtime and prevent foodborne hazards. Kitchen employees must diligently verify and document internal food temperatures, utilizing calibrated thermometers to ensure that cooking, reheating, and cooling assets are functioning within precise regulatory parameters.

3.5. Restaurant Managers

Shall be responsible for overseeing the operational execution of the preventive maintenance policy at the store level and ensuring overall compliance within the retail environment. The Restaurant Manager coordinates with the Facility Manager and third-party contractors to schedule mandatory maintenance windows that minimize disruption to guest services. This role is strictly tasked with verifying that store-level equipment logs are maintained accurately, ensuring all front-of-house and back-of-house assets meet local regulatory standards, and escalating unresolved mechanical or temperature anomalies for prompt corrective action.

3.6. Shift Managers

Shall be responsible for serving as the direct line of supervision during active operational shifts to ensure continuous adherence to food safety and equipment protocols. Shift Managers must actively monitor the real-time performance of refrigeration units and culinary equipment, ensuring that all employees conduct and document routine temperature checks at required intervals. In the event of an unscheduled breakdown or temperature deviation, the Shift Manager is responsible for enforcing immediate isolation protocols, initiating product holds on potentially compromised inventory, and reporting the malfunction instantly to management and the maintenance team.

4. Master Maintenance Schedule (MMS)

The effective management of facility equipment and safety protocols relies on a structured hierarchy of accountability across several departments. Facility Leadership and the Warehouse Manager hold primary oversight, managing the master maintenance schedule and ensuring that any deficiencies identified in previous audits are systematically addressed. Supporting the technical integrity of the operation, Quality Assurance (QA) is tasked with the validation of equipment calibrations, specifically focusing on the accuracy of industrial sensors and continuous temperature monitoring logs. Meanwhile, the Maintenance Team and Lead Auditor execute the physical oversight of the facility by conducting direct inspections of industrial production lines and maintaining detailed documentation of large-scale cleaning and maintenance cycles. Finally, Kitchen and Commissary Employees serve as the essential first line of observation; they are responsible for the immediate reporting of any equipment malfunctions and must verify internal temperatures during the "kill step" to ensure all machinery is functioning within safety parameters.

5. Maintenance Procedures & Food Safety Protocols

To prevent contamination, technicians must log all tools and parts while strictly avoiding temporary fasteners like tape or wire. Only permitted by the National Sanitation Foundation is the NSF H1 food-grade lubricants and these must be stored in labeled cabinets away from production zones. Before returning machinery to service, employees must clear all debris and follow SSOP sanitation protocols. Production may only resume once Quality Assurance verifies cleanliness via visual inspection or ATP swab and officially signs the work order release.

6. Calibration of Monitoring Equipment

Any device used to measure a Critical Control Point (CCP) or Process Control (PC) must be calibrated to ensure accuracy, with all calibrations being strictly traceable to national standards such as National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST). Furthermore, as a corrective action, if a device is found to be out of calibration, all products produced since the last "good" calibration check must be immediately placed on Quality Hold for a comprehensive safety evaluation.

7. Emergency & Corrective Maintenance

In the event of an unscheduled breakdown, operations or production must cease immediately if the mechanical failure poses a direct risk to food safety, such as in cases of a cooling leak or observed metal-to-metal contact. Following the stoppage, a **Corrective Maintenance Report** must be filed to document the incident thoroughly. This report is required to detail the root cause of the failure, ensuring that specific preventative measures are implemented to mitigate the risk of recurrence.

8. Spare Parts Management

To maintain operational efficiency and food safety standards, critical spare parts such as gaskets, seals, and sensors must be kept on-site to minimize potential downtime during repairs. These components must be stored in their original packaging or within sealed containers to protect them from environmental contamination. Maintaining this level of organization ensures that when a part is needed, it remains in pristine, sanitary condition and is ready for immediate installation.

9. Record Keeping & Auditing

To maintain a comprehensive audit trail, all records related to this policy must be retained for a minimum of two years. This documentation includes Preventive Maintenance Logs (PM Logs), Work Orders, and Contractor Service Reports, alongside Calibration Certificates that verify equipment accuracy. Furthermore, post-maintenance sanitation sign-offs must be archived to provide evidence that the production environment was returned to a sanitary state before resuming operations.

10. Training

All maintenance personnel and third-party contractors must receive annual training on Good Manufacturing Practices (GMPs) and the specific requirements of this policy before performing work in production areas.

11. Corrective Action

11.1. Identification and Isolation

Upon discovery of an equipment failure or a missed preventive maintenance (PM) task, production on the affected line must come to an immediate halt if the failure presents a risk of physical contamination, such as metal fragments, or a significant temperature deviation. Concurrent with this stoppage, a product hold must be initiated for all items produced since the last documented "passed" inspection or successful PM check. These products are to be Orange Tagged and isolated for a comprehensive safety evaluation to ensure that no compromised goods reach the consumer.

11.2. Root Cause Analysis (RCA)

To effectively prevent the recurrence of an equipment failure or missed preventive maintenance, the Maintenance Team and Facility Leadership are required to conduct a thorough analysis to identify the underlying cause. This investigation must categorize the failure into one of three primary areas: Human Error, where a PM was skipped or performed incorrectly; Material Failure, involving a part failing prematurely before its expected lifespan; or a Design Issue, where the equipment itself is deemed unsuitable for the current production volume. By pinpointing whether the issue stems from procedural gaps, component quality, or engineering limitations, leadership can implement targeted strategies to stabilize the production line.

11.3. Restoration and Food Safety Release

Before equipment can return to "Active" status, a rigorous "Clean Break" protocol must be executed to ensure both mechanical integrity and food safety. This process begins with the Mechanical Repair, which must be completed using strictly food-grade materials to avoid chemical contamination. Once the repair is finalized, the equipment undergoes a thorough Sanitation phase in accordance with Standard Sanitary Operating Procedures (SSOPs) to eliminate any tools, metal shavings, or lubricants used during the maintenance. Following sanitation, Verification is required, where Quality Assurance (QA) conducts a visual inspection and/or an ATP swab test to confirm the surface is biologically and physically clean. Finally, the process concludes with a formal Sign-off, where the Corrective Action Report (CAR) is countersigned by both Maintenance and QA, officially authorizing the equipment's return to production.

12. Change History

Revision No.:	Revision Date:	Author & Position:	Purpose of Revision
0	April 21, 2026	Celine Joy Sanchez, **QA Specialist**	Originator
1	May 25, 2026	Celine Joy Sanchez, **QA Specialist**	• Added Responsibilities
2	June 4, 2025	Celine Joy Sanchez, **QA Specialist**	• Revised the Facility and warehouse manager responsibilities

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